



CHAPTER IX

THE FIRST IRON CASTING

1853

Mormonism, especially in the early days of the church, was not only a religion, but the leaders also dealt with everyday duties. They were expected to minister to the social, economic, health and political wants of the members as well as to their spiritual needs.¹ Everything revolved around the L.D.S. Church. Religion was not only good for Sunday contemplation, but had to do with dollars and cents, trade and barter, and with the daily doings of ordinary life. As a member of the Iron County Stake Presidency, Henry was placed in a position of authority over the settlers in Cedar Fort. He was called in on most matters of importance including economic matters, social problems, and administering to the sick, which he did frequently.

Henry stayed home from church on Sunday, February 12, due to a painful toothache. Usually when a tooth got bad enough they simply pulled it or sooner or later it got better on its own.

Henry and Ellen were very thankful for their new home. They entertained quite often. Henry wrote: "I am truly thankful to my Heavenly Father that we have a good comfortable little house of our own to make brethren and sisters comfortable."

Three men from Salt Lake City passed through Cedar City on Monday on their way to California. They brought some mail and newspapers with them. They told the settlers that the people in Salt

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Lake City had lost many sheep and cattle during the winter because of the severity of the weather.

President J. C. L. Smith came from Parowan on Tuesday, February 22. Henry wrote the following about their conversation:

There are a number of brethren who are working at the Iron Works who are in want of wheat. Neither Brother Smith nor myself are able to get any for them as the news has lately come from Salt Lake City that wheat is likely to be scarce before harvest. Those in our midst, and at Parowan, who have wheat to spare will not part with it at the cash price, namely 1 1/4 dollars per bushel. As the Bishop at Parowan, or here, has not received instructions from the Presiding Bishop in Salt Lake City, he will not part with the wheat for less than the old price, 2 dollars per bushel. I am sorry to see saints keep their wheat locked up because they think they can make a little more out of it by keeping it for a while. I have preached over and over against this principle and instructed the brethren to be liberal minded towards each other and turn out their wheat and not think of speculating out of their brethren and charge them higher. The principle is an old gentle, devilish principle, and therefore not good for saints.

Six men from San Bernardino, California, passed through Cedar City on February 25, 1853, on their way to Salt Lake City. They were carrying mail with them. Henry wrote a letter to the *Deseret News* and sent it with them when they left the next morning. The letter, which appeared in the newspaper on March 19, follows:

Cedar, Iron County, Feb. 26, 1853. All is peace, prosperity, and best of health in this colony, and praise be the name of the Lord for his goodness unto us. We have had very sharp frosts at nights for the last month

but delightful fine days. The ground this morning is white with a slight fall of snow the past night.

We have taken up the fence from around the big field and made another small field on the south side of Coal Creek below the new city--will be completed by the 1st of March with an excellent fence all round it 6 poles high and 2 good strong lumber gates to enter. A dam and water course is in operation to water the city and field. The new city plat has already on it 9 log houses, 2 adobe houses and 10 good cellars, all inhabited.

We number in the colony, fort and city together, 70 men, about half of which are regularly employed by the Deseret Iron Company. The blast was put on to the furnace this morning. There is a variety of ores on the ground calcined, ready for experiment. We fully expect, this time, to become acquainted with the knowledge of manufacturing iron from the ores which so richly abound in this country. An excellent air furnace is nearly finished, built of adobes and rock with a tunnel, 300 feet long, to convey the smoke to a chimney stack, 40 feet high, which we are in progress of building. The stack is so constructed as to answer for 4 furnaces, when completed. An extensive frame building is erected for a 'casting house.' Yours, Henry Lunt.

P. S. It will be well for the saints who come here this spring to provide themselves with garden seeds.

Walker, the Indian Chief, and a small band have been camped here for the last three weeks and are very peaceable.²

Several days later Henry wrote the following:

Tuesday, March 1: Commenced again making another trial [in the furnace] at 2 p.m. In about one

hour we had an excellent cinder. She appeared to be doing better. Brother J. C. L. Smith came about the time the blast was put on. We counseled together considerable during the afternoon. He returned to Parowan in the evening. We concluded to get some wheat off the Bishop for the workmen, as the money which Snow and Richards left with us, was all gone.

The charge that was put in the furnace consisted of 100 pounds of charcoal, 30 pounds of iron ore from the West Mountain, 20 pounds of bog ore and 20 pounds of limestone. They used 48 of these charges during an eighteen hour period, after which about 250 pounds of iron ran out of the blast furnace early on the morning of March 2. The iron seemed to vary a little in quality, some was gray but most was white and very hard.³

That day Doctor Meeks came from Parowan and told Henry that he would volunteer his time to give a lecture and demonstration on what to do for the sick. Henry wrote the following in his journal:

I recommended the principle strongly for each one to become his or her own doctor. Myself and wife had supper with Brother and Sister Chatterley. After supper I invited Doctor Meeks and a party of about a dozen brethren and sisters to Brother Chatterley's house where Doctor Meeks gave instructions on medicines, midwifery, etc. We had a very interesting and instructive chat together.

The blast furnace was burning nearly 200 bushels of coal every 24 hours. On Thursday the settlers dispensed with Fast day on account of so many hands being needed at the furnace. That evening Henry preached a discourse on the importance of being united in making iron. Because they were nearly out of coal he instructed the miners to go and search and dig for more. They closed the furnace on Friday, March 5, due to lack of coal. In order to search for coal up the canyon it was necessary to remove nearly two feet of snow, but they

kept on working, even though the weather was extremely cold and it was snowing.⁴

Brother Peter Shirts came to see the Lunts that evening, March 4, and told Henry that he was offended by what Philip K. Smith, Bishop of the Cedar City ward, had said against him. Henry wrote about the incident:

I would here remark that the Bishop is entirely too fast at talking in meetings, and he often hurts my mind very much. He is always wanting to talk in meeting and he talks too tremendously loud and with that authority which causes brethren, very often, to have their feelings wounded. I counseled Brother Shirts not to feel hurt about it nor to go to the Bishop about it as he was going to, wanting me to accompany him. I told him to do right and be patient and the thing would work itself out all right in the end. Brother Shirts thanked me for the advice and said he would take it.

Henry and Ellen had made the decision to go to Salt Lake City to attend L.D.S. Conference which was scheduled to begin on April 6, and continue for five days. Brother George A. Smith and several of the Twelve Apostles had counseled them to go and get their endowments. If everything went smoothly, most travelers made the trip in less than two weeks. Henry and the iron workers were determined to make a suitable iron casting of good quality to take on this trip to show the brethren in Salt Lake City. There was much to be accomplished in preparation for this trip. Henry went to Parowan on March 15 to see if he could borrow a team of horses but had little success. He wrote the following about the iron casting:

Thursday, March 17, 1853: I left Parowan for Cedar City, arriving home about noon. Went up to the Iron Works and found the brethren very busily engaged at the cupola. At 4 o'clock p.m. they cast an excellent

'dog iron' [hand iron] which caused our hearts to rejoice very much to see the first casting of iron made in the mountains. We gave three cheers and cried Hosannah to God and the Lamb forever and ever, and three cheers for Iron County. Attended prayer meeting in the evening. I spoke to encourage the brethren to roll on at the Iron Works. We had an excellent meeting and a spirit of energy and enterprise seemed to be in the bosom of many of the brethren.

Henry preached a discourse on Sunday, March 20, which pertained to their mission of making iron. Thirty-three brethren stood up and volunteered to devote all their time to it. They met in the Casting House the following morning where they were organized to work to the best advantage. They had decided to try wood in the blast furnace so they met again in the evening at the Fort to encourage the farmers to haul wood for the Iron Works. Henry wrote:

We met in the evening opposite the school house, but the farmers were very backward at promising to do anything for the Iron Works. I invited them and warned them not to have their minds so much on farming, as they were not sent here to farm.

Tuesday, March 22, 1853: The brethren tried the raw wood and it melted the iron in the cupola first rate and two wheels and two pedestals were molded and looked splendid. I had recommended the brethren for to try the raw pitch pine many times, even from the first, but they would not.

Since the weather was unpredictable at this time of year, Henry and Ellen decided to leave for Salt Lake early to allow ample time. They left from Cedar City March 23, 1853, at about 11 o'clock in the morning. Henry was able to borrow a horse and a mule to draw their wagon. They had planned to leave earlier but the horse had gotten out of the pen during the night and they were unable to find him. One

of the men traveling with them, Robert Kershaw, loaned them one of his horses. They left with several other wagons including Bishop Philip K. Smith and family, Brother George Wood and his two wives, Brother and Sister Bosnell, and Brother and Sister Walker. They stayed in Parowan the first night. Henry stated: "Most tremendous windy night, could not sleep for the dust and wind."

When they left early the next morning, more families from Parowan joined the group. They traveled about 35 miles that day to Beaver. The Walkers broke the axle on their wagon so Sister Walker traveled on with Henry and Ellen and slept with Ellen in the wagon that night while Henry stayed with Robert Kershaw. Brother Bosnell went back to help Walker fix the broken axle and they got into camp about midnight.

When they left the next morning, they were faced with crossing two creeks. Henry wrote: "The Beaver crossing was a bad one--steep pitch into the creek. Several of the teams had trouble crossing the two creeks. Ellen and I crossed first rate, but Brother Walker broke the iron work in the front part of his buggy and had to leave it. We took some of his belongings." The company met some Cedar City residents coming from Salt Lake City about seven miles north of Beaver. These travelers informed them that they had suffered much from the snow and weather and had been traveling for 23 days. They brought some mail with them which contained a letter to Henry from Brothers Snow and Richards. They also had about \$900 worth of drygoods and groceries for the residents in southern Utah. Sister Wiley, wife of Robert Wiley whom Henry had stayed with in Parowan, was in the returning group and was very glad to see the Lunts.

Henry's group continued on for about 14 miles that night and camped in the mouth of a canyon where there was no water but plenty of wood and good feed for the animals. They melted snow for their needs. Ellen cooked a meal of beef tongue, butter, eggs and bread which they washed down with a good cup of tea given to them by Sister Cartwright. Henry wrote: "It is twelve months today since I and Ellen were married, and I thank the Lord for his manifold blessings and mercies rendered unto us."

They decided to organize the camp into a company with Silas H.

Smith as Captain, Henry Lunt as Clerk, Edward Dalton as Sergeant of the Guard, W. Y. Webb as Pilot, and Philip K. Smith as Chaplain. After their meeting around the campfire, they sang "Come Let Us Anew, Our Journey Pursue." The horses were allowed to run loose during the night but the men took two hour shifts, two men at a time, guarding the camp. Henry wrote: "Saturday, March 26: The camp started at 5 o'clock. The ground being frozen hard, we traveled good to Pine Creek. We traveled over snow in places from one to three feet deep. I was the 6th wagon. Myself and wife walked part of the road. The grass is just beginning to shoot out green."

The company continued on to Cove Creek where they camped and rested until midnight and then continued traveling through the night. Henry recorded:

The moon was but a little past full, it was very light and pleasant but very cold riding. Arrived on Corn Creek Sunday, March 27, just as the 'king of day' was sending forth his majestic rays of warmth and light over the valleys of the mountains, and the spring birds charmed our ears with their singing.

The travelers arrived in Fillmore, a settlement of about fifty families, about noon that day and attended church since it was Sunday. Henry was invited to speak about Coal Creek. He exhibited the "hand irons" which he had brought to show in conference.

During the course of the trip they met several groups of people going south, some to Parowan and Cedar City and some on their way to California. After the group crossed through Dry Valley and easily crossed the Sevier River on an excellent bridge, they were joined on Wednesday, March 30, by some people from Sanpete and they all reached Nephi at 9:00 a.m. that day. The Indians there had killed a grizzly bear a few days before and Henry bought some of the fat which Ellen rendered into about a half pint of grease. Henry said, "It came in first rate as oil for our hair." The couple knew hospitable people along the way who were willing to open their homes to the weary travelers. Nephi was also a settlement of about fifty families.

The roads were much better and were kept in better repair as they got closer to Salt Lake City. The company reached Payson on Thursday, March 31, where the Lunts went to see Brother Daniels, a man who had crossed the plains in Henry's company. His wife invited them to dinner and, when they left, she gave them some butter and asked them to stop on their return trip. There were about forty houses in this settlement. They passed through several smaller towns in this area. Henry wrote:

Rolled on again about ten miles and 'baited' our horses for about two hours. Saw a large settlement on Spanish Fork Creek called Palmyra. The water in the creek was high and muddy but there was a good bridge. Passed through Springville which is the finest settlement I have seen on the road--beautiful for situation, some 100 houses and many excellent buildings of adobes with shingle roofs. This city bids fair for one of the most delightful in the Territory. The prairie about Springville is beautiful and green with new grass appearing thick like turf in the old country. Rolled on the way and found ourselves a little after sundown in the midst of a large thriving city called Provo.

The group had traveled 33 miles that day. The Lunts stayed with Brother Whipple and his wives in Provo. He had been in Henry's company when they came across the plains. Henry recorded:

After supper I took Ellen with me to see Brother and Sister Fish who gave us a drink of whisky. There are two thousand inhabitants in this city and a great number of most excellent buildings. It is astonishing to see the rapid progress and improvements made in the valleys of the mountains. A little over two years since, there was nothing, and now there are cities being built of immense magnitude and the area

assumes the appearance of an old settled country. Then, when I passed through, there were only four houses at Payson and but an old shabby fort at Provo. [The 'Word of Wisdom,' as Joseph Smith had announced it, had not been a binding commandment in early Mormonism. It seemed to be condoned in connection with the 'grow your own or do without' program.]

On the afternoon of April 2, 1853, the Lunts stopped in Holidaysburg, a little settlement about two hours from Salt Lake City, and visited with Brother Milo Andrus who had traveled across the ocean on the same ship as Henry. Brother Andrus had a good comfortable adobe house where he lived with his three wives. They invited the Lunts to spend the night but, after eating a very good dinner, Henry and Ellen decided to continue on to Salt Lake City. Andrus agreed to care for their animals during their stay, so the next day, after the Lunts reached Salt Lake, Henry paid two boys a half dollar to take his horse and mule back to the Andruses in Holidaysburg. Henry wrote:

The Great Salt Lake City has the appearance of a city which is different to what it had been when I left a little over two years since. Houses are quite numerous. Some hundred homes have been erected in that time and some very good ones too. The Tabernacle is a very fine building, also the Council House and Store House. They could grace the city of London. Met with several brethren that I knew as I was passing through the streets. Called and saw Brother George A. Smith. He was pleased to see me and said, 'God bless Brother Henry.' Brother Amasa Lyman came to us and invited us to call and see him. Brother James Bond came to us in the street and invited us to go and see him on Sunday without fail. We then drove to Brother James Haslam's house, an

acquaintance of Ellen. They made us very welcome and we talked over many things and retired to rest as the sweet strains of music from the brass band serenaded the city.

Henry and Ellen attended meeting in the Tabernacle on Sunday, April 3, and stayed after the services to listen to the choir sing. In the evening they went to a meeting with the Haslams in the 15th Ward where Henry was called on to preach. Henry recorded the following account of their stay in Salt Lake City:

April 4, 1853: Myself and Ellen took a walk up in town and called on Brother Kane at the post office to pay him \$19.50 on the *Deseret News* account. We visited President Brigham Young and talked to him some on the iron business. He seemed glad that we had brought a sample of castings. We next called on Brother Erastus Snow, after which we went to Brother Clinton's where we stayed the whole of the day. Brother Clinton has a brewery and he gave us plenty of Porter and Ale.

Tuesday, April 5, 1853: Beautiful fine day. Transacted our business at the stores, but found them nearly empty--not a print or a calico to be had. Met with President Young who told me they could not give any more endowments until they had a fresh supply of oil. Visited the sugar works, machine shop and public work shops and was astonished to find the great amount of machinery and improvements that have been made. To see the machinery and buildings in this city that are already erected is a miracle of the present age. That evening we went to the Social Hall and heard the band play--nearly forty performers. A splendid band. Brother Parley P. Pratt and I had a good deal of chat together. We then called on Erastus Snow again and returned to our lodgings.

Wednesday, April 6: Myself and Ellen witnessed the laying of the corner stones of the foundation of the temple. There were more than five thousand saints present. To see the order and hear the music and see the troops of soldiers with their flags and the large flag floating from the top of the Liberty Pole was truly an imposing sight and a day long to be remembered. We attended conference in the Tabernacle at 10 a.m. which was called to order by President Young. The choir sang and a prayer was given by John Taylor. Then, the procession formed at the vestry and we marched to the temple ground. I saw the Presidency lay the southeast corner stone and the Council of the Twelve laid the northeast corner stone. Bishop Hunter and Council laid the southwest corner and the High Priests laid the northwest corner which was supposed to weigh five tons. The other three stones weighed three tons each. There was an oration, prayer and singing at the laying of each stone. The smiles of an overruling providence beamed richly upon the saints as they were engaged in the great, and long to be remembered, work of laying the foundation stones of the House of the God of Jacob in the valleys of the mountains. Met with a number of brethren and sisters that I had known, some that had traveled over the sea with me, others up the river or across the plains, some from Birmingham in England and other places. Brother Brigham gave notice to the conference that the doors of the Tabernacle would be open at seven o'clock in the morning and the brethren were invited to preach and occupy time until ten o'clock.

Thursday, April 7: I and Ellen attended meeting in the Tabernacle at eight o'clock. The brethren did not fully occupy the time as was wished for, so I occupied a short time myself. I told the saints of our prosperity at Coal Creek in the iron business and that

we had brought along a pair of cast iron 'hand irons.' Soon after I had spoken, Dr. Sprig brought the hand irons out of the vestry and placed them on the front of the stand. The saints appeared quite excited and well pleased at the sample of cast iron made in the mountains by the saints. Brigham Young, Orson Hyde, and Erastus Snow preached in the morning session. Parley P. Pratt preached in the afternoon. We had supper with Brother Wilford Woodruff and took a walk around the block afterwards with Brother Woodruff and his wife.

Meetings continued on Friday, Saturday, and Sunday. On Saturday Henry went with a Brother Furguson and company to the court house and heard the sentences passed on three men for stealing cattle. One was fined \$200 and one year's imprisonment with "ball and chain" attached. The other two were fined \$100 and given six months imprisonment. Henry attended a meeting of Seventies that evening in the Tabernacle where there were approximately two thousand Elders in attendance.

Henry and Ellen stayed in Salt Lake a few days longer than they had anticipated because of the stormy weather. On Tuesday, April 12, Henry went to the Council House with George A. Smith and spent some time conversing with a group of men about sending out missionaries to all the nations to preach the Gospel. Those in attendance were: Brigham Young, Willard Richards, Orson Hyde, John Taylor, Franklin D. Richards, Erastus Snow, Lorenzo Snow, Daniel Wells, Jed. I. Grant, G. D. Watt, W. W. Phelps, George A. Smith, Henry Lunt and several others. Henry wrote: "As I left the room President Young blessed me in the name of the Lord."

It was nearly two o'clock in the afternoon on Wednesday, April 13, before Ellen and Henry said goodbye, visited with their friends and departed for home. They had trouble on the entire trip with the team they had borrowed. It seems that every time they were ready to leave, they first had to search for the horse and the mule. Everything went well on Thursday, but on Friday they could not find either of the

animals until noon, so they didn't reach Springville until that night. They were joined there by several other wagons traveling their direction, one of which belonged to Brother Walker. They camped the next night at the springs in Juab Valley where they saw several antelope "skipping and playing" on the side of the mountain.

Henry started on Sunday morning at 5:00 a.m. to help Brother Walker find his horse, "Jack," but didn't get on their way until 10:30 a.m. They reached Salt Creek that night and Henry wrote: "The mosquitoes are very unpleasant customers here. Stayed a short time on Chicken Creek and, after breakfast and baiting our animals, went on to the Sevier and baited again there." Besides having trouble with the horses, Henry suffered with a toothache most of the way home. The provisions were barely adequate, so it helped considerably to be given food and lodging by friends in many of the settlements.

In crossing a deep ravine a short distance south of Meadow Creek, one of the "whippletrees" on their wagon broke. Henry wrote: "Robert Kershaw went to the creek and got a birch stick, and we soon found ourselves 'Yankee' enough to make another, and we rolled on again." The travelers arrived at Cedar Fort on Saturday, April 23, at about 5:00 p.m. They were warmly greeted by Father and Mother Whittaker and many others. Henry wrote: "When we were but about 200 yards from the Fort, one of the wheels came off of our wagon, but no harm was done. We have had a very prosperous journey. I pray that we may retain the Spirit that was manifested by the Authorities at conference."

Life soon got back to normal and on Sunday, April 24, 1853, Henry preached a lengthy discourse to the congregation on the immediate necessity of making articles of iron. The following Sunday, May 1, Erastus Snow, Judge Zerababel Snow, Amasa Lyman, Charles C. Rich and a company of ten men arrived in Cedar Fort. They were sent by Governor Young on a reconnoitering expedition. They brought some merchandise for the settlers, and Henry and J. C. L. Smith spent most of Tuesday and Wednesday selling the goods to the residents for cash. Erastus Snow and Judge Snow spent several days with Henry in counsel on matters mostly pertaining to the Iron Works. A meeting was held on Thursday afternoon, May 12, where Brother

Erastus Snow preached a delightful discourse which caused the hearts of the people to rejoice. After the meeting was dismissed, the brethren were requested to "tarry" to transact some business. The meeting lasted until 4:00 a.m. Henry kept the following minutes:

President Snow said that if the brethren had done the best they could he was satisfied. He was aware that Brother J. C. L. Smith had not devoted but a small portion of his time to the superintending of the Iron Works. President Smith said he had more business on his hands than what he could attend to and he would be very glad to be released from the duties of the Iron Works. Brothers Bosnell, Cartwright, Wood, and Carruthers said they were willing to support Brother Smith and thought it would be best for him to retain his office as Superintendent of the Works until the general meeting in the fall. President Snow recommended Brother Smith to counsel with the brethren of the Iron Works from time to time. He said he would have an office built at the Works for the clerk and a warehouse room which would also answer for a council room. Brother Snow proposed that Brother Smith have a council of five to help him bear the burden. The following brethren were unanimously chosen to be his councillors: Matthew Carruthers, Henry Lunt, Richard Harrison, Thomas Bladen, and David Adams.

President Snow said he wished Brother Lunt to attend to the books and back up Brother Calvin Smith and counsel with him and stand, as Brother Willard Richards did, keeper of the rolls. He observed that Brother Lunt had the Presidency of the church over his branch and a great deal on his shoulders, and he has sufficient to attend to without having the superintendence of the Works. Brother Snow did not want him to stand and 'catch all the sparks' and get

the ill will of the brethren. He wished Brother Henry to attend to his office as Presiding Elder of the Branch and for to administer to the saints in spiritual things--look over and watch over the people.

Brother Carruthers was instructed to stand in Brother Calvin Smith's place as Superintendent of the Works during his absence and look over the men to take their time and see that they do not idle away their time. Brother Bosnell found considerable fault with Brother Bladen as regards to his qualifications as a worker in wood. Brother Bladen, in return, found fault with Bosnell and both manifested a spirit of disunion and hatred, one towards another. President Snow reproved Bosnell and Bladen for the unwise manner in which they conducted themselves and then gave considerable instructions to all the brethren. He said he wanted Brother Bateman for to make fire brick for the arch of the air furnace as the adobes had proved a failure and would not stand the fire, in consequence of which, the furnace had not yet had a fair trial.

President Snow said he had decided to have a fort built near to the Iron Works for the brethren to live in who would be constantly employed at the Works. He suggested that the lots and entire fort be in the hands of the Deseret Iron Company. He recommended the houses to be built uniform, neat and good. He thought of proposing that the brethren turn in the field to the Company and for the Company to employ a few good hands to farm it, but he inquired for the feelings of the brethren on it and there was very little said. The feelings, however, seemed to be for everyone to farm his own. It was moved and carried, unanimously, that Brother Snow select a site for a field for the Deseret Iron Company.

On Sunday, May 15, 1853, Henry counseled the settlers not to scatter out on the city lots, to strengthen the fort and make it secure, to lock the gates every night and to have their guns and ammunition on hand. He recommended that the brethren establish a herd and have someone stay with the cattle at all times. Samuel Kershaw agreed to guard the herd for three dollars a day.

Henry and Ellen planted a garden on Thursday, May 19. Henry wrote:

About ½ past 4 p.m. it began to thunder and lightning over Shirt's Canyon and, in a few minutes, the whole heavens were black with clouds and the lightning and thunder began to approach very near and was tremendously loud. The wind began to blow in a most terrific manner and large drops of rain descended. I and Ellen went into the house. She sat down near to the fireplace and I went to the wood pile for some wood for the fire. As I came through the door, I pushed it wide open and, just as I was in the attitude of laying the wood down by the side of the fireplace, the electric fluid struck the chimney of the house accompanied by the loudest burst of thunder I ever before heard--knocked a part of the chimney down, rent the house from top to bottom, blew the mantle piece to pieces, took a piece out of the floor, knocked the bottom out of a Keeler which was full of water, made a hole in a box, knocked the plaster off the wall, tore one of the shoes to pieces on my wife's foot and a large hole into the other and took the use out of both of her legs for some time. I had to carry her out of the house, and at the same time my own legs were burning with heat as though I had been in a fire. We were both of us sensible at the time, and are now. Had it not been for an overruling providence which had shielded us from the danger, we most certainly should have, both of us, been instantly killed.

It was the most awful scene I ever witnessed and certainly will never be forgotten. Attended meeting in the evening and found that Brother Cook's boy was knocked down about 100 yards from my house. Brother Smith and Brother Carruthers came to my house a few minutes after the scene and brought a sample of coal, which was of an excellent quality, that the brethren had dug out of the old mine.

The weather had warmed up considerably and the men who were working at the coal mine dug deeper in search of a larger vein. Some of the settlers were working on the road up the canyon to the mine. By the middle of June they started working a large deposit of coal which had been located the preceding winter. Bishop Smith and Henry visited the mine and found there was a nine-foot vein of "pure coal" (this mine was in Right Hand Canyon).⁵

There had been an unusual amount of snow during the winter and the water in Coal Creek was higher than the settlers had ever seen it. Most of the inhabitants had a garden planted and were making good use of the water. Brother Morris repaired the chimney for the Lunts and Henry finished putting up the fence around his garden plot on Friday, May 27. He also butchered one of his two pigs because he could not afford to keep two.

Moses, an Indian, made a much needed pair of moccasins for both Ellen and Henry. William Bateman arrived from Salt Lake City on June 17, and Henry rode out to see him by the knoll north of town. They had a long, interesting chat. Bateman said that provisions were scarce in Salt Lake Valley and the grasshoppers were destroying the wheat crops.

Henry Lunt and John Steele, with their wives and a few other couples went with the Stake Presidency, consisting of Pres, Smith and his two counselors, to visit Brothers Shirts who lived about five miles south of Cedar City. They first went to the settlement of Harmony by way of Kanarra Creek. The citizens of Harmony were in good health and spirits and were busy watering their crops. Those who lived there were J. D. Lee, Elisha H. Groves, Charles Dalton, Solomon

Chamberlain and their wives and families. They had built a good fort enclosure and had about sixty acres of land under cultivation. The Cedar brethren occupied the time in church meeting the next morning and got on their way. As there was a thunder storm that night, they stayed at Shirt's settlement. There were four families living there: Peter Shirts, J. Hamilton, Robert Henry, Brother Anderson and families. The place was fortified in, and the crops looked well in a very good location. The moon eclipsed that night which was quite a sight to behold. They left for Cedar the next morning.

Henry wrote the following concerning the building of homes in the new location designated for the new Fort:

Thursday, June 30, 1853: There are several adobe houses being erected on our new city plot [Plat A]. Brother Flack has the walls of a house up with two rooms. Brother Leigh has one up the same. Brother Griffith has also one room up. Brothers Robert Roberts, Dakin, and Wilden are putting a house up each and the foundations of several others are being laid. There are a good many of the brethren making adobes. The men in this colony are very industrious, and I don't think that any set of people ever did more in the time that the settlers have done here.

1. Leonard J. Arrington, *The Great Basin Kingdom*, (Lincoln, Nebraska: University of Nebraska Press, 1966) Page 133.
2. Henry Lunt, *Deseret News*, March 19, 1853.
3. *Deseret Iron Company Minute Book*, 1853 Entry, William R. Palmer collection, Special Collections Library, Southern Utah University, Cedar City, Utah.
4. Henry Lunt, "Henry Lunt Journal," March 10, 1853, (Provo, Utah: B.Y.U. Library, copied from original journal, 1955), p. 159.
5. *Ibid.*, June 15, 1853, p. 204.